

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 10 5 4

♥ 8 4

♦ J 10 9 6

♣ J 8 2

♠ A K 6

♥ A 10 3

♦ A 8 2

♣ 10 9 7 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 9 2

♥ K Q J 9 7 5

♦ K Q 3

♣ 6

♠ 8 7 3

♥ 6 2

♦ 7 5 4

♣ A K Q 5 3

West

North

East

South

1NT

2♥

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

You need two more winners. Barring a 4-0 ♣ split your two extra winners will be the ♣5 and ♣3.

So after winning the ♥A, you play a ♣ to dummy's ♣Q and breathe a sigh of relief when both defenders follow suit.

UhOh. Surely you didn't play your ♣4 to dummy's ♣Q???

If you did then just look at the situation now. If the ♣J doesn't fall on the next trick the suit will be blocked. Now go back in time and play the ♣10 to dummy's ♣Q.

That's better. Now under the ♣ A K you can unblock the ♣ 9 7, which will leave you with the ♣4 to slip under dummy's ♣5.

Watch those spot cards. You may have to unblock them to stay in the hand you want to be in.

Partner's jump to 3NT is a lebensohl method.

He is describing a hand with which he would have bid 3NT if there had been no overcall. But he is warning you that he **DOES NOT HAVE** a ♥ stopper!

Since you **DO** have a ♥ stopper you decide to pass and play 3NT.

North plays 3NT. East leads the ♥K.

You hold up your ♥A until the third round.

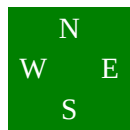
Winner List: ♠ = 2 : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = 1 : ♣ = 3 :: Total = 7

Board 2

South Deals
None Vul

♠ 10 8 7
♥ 10 4
♦ K 9 7 5
♣ K 10 9 5

♠ K Q J 9 5 3
♥ K J 7
♦ 6 2
♣ 8 4



♠ 6
♥ Q 9 8 5 3 2
♦ Q 10
♣ A J 6 3

♠ A 4 2
♥ A 6
♦ A J 8 4 3
♣ Q 7 2

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	2♥	Pass	2♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			
4♠ by South			

You decide to use a transfer so the lead will be into whatever holding partner has in the minor suits. You bid 2♥ and partner bids 2♠.

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You are nowhere near strong enough to be thinking of slam so you bid 4♠.

The contract would be 4♠ played by North.

South plays 4♠. West leads the ♣10. East wins the ♣A. They continue ♣s and you ruff the third one in dummy.

Loser List: ♠ = 0 : ♥ = 0 : ♦ = 1 : ♣ = 2 :: Total = 3

Those losers are based on dummy's hand, not yours. You can figure them either way but it is usually easier to determine losers based on the long-trump hand. It's important to remember it in this Deal because the zero losers in ♥s assumes you will ruff a ♥ in your hand.

Pull one round of trumps with dummy's ♠K. Both defenders follow suit. Play the ♥A, then ♥6 to dummy's ♥K. On this trick West follows with the ♥10.

The Plan is still the same, you will ruff the ♥ in your hand, but you better be sure to ruff with your ♠A. Aha! Your precaution pays off when West shows out of ♥s, but of course he cannot over-ruff your ♠A.

A very good Bridge maxim is this: When you are ruffing, ruff with as high a trump as you can afford.

Here, with only 2 trumps left out, you can afford the ♠A.

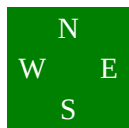
Board 3

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A
 ♥ 10 8 5 2
 ♦ 9 8 5 3
 ♣ A 10 8 7

♠ Q J 4
 ♥ A K 6
 ♦ K Q J
 ♣ J 5 4 3



♠ 7 3 2
 ♥ J 9 7 4 3
 ♦ A 10 6
 ♣ 9 2

♠ K 10 9 8 6 5
 ♥ Q
 ♦ 7 4 2
 ♣ K Q 6

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	2♥
Pass	2♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			

4♠ by North

So before playing any trumps play ♥ A K, discarding dummy's ♣K. That's a lot of winners you are wasting but you can afford it.

Only then can you afford to play a ♠. West can win the ♠A, but if he plays a ♣ dummy will be able to over-ruff East.

After you pull trumps you can drive out the ♦A and claim the contract.

As you see, trying even one round of trumps would have been fatal.

You had to get rid of dummy's singleton ♥ first - the fact that it was a winner should not affect your making the correct play.

Partner's 2♥ bid is a transfer so you bid 2♠. Partner now bids 4♠ and you pass.

North plays 4♠. East leads the ♣9. West takes the ♣A, then returns the ♣7 on which East plays the ♣2.

Loser List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 0 : ♦ = 1 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 3

Careful! Although it looks like only 3 losers you are in real danger of a ♣ ruff. It is almost certain that East has led a doubleton ♣ so if West can get the lead with either ♠A or ♦A they will get the ruff.

Fortunately your ♦s are solid and you do not need the ♥Q as a winner.

Board 4

East Deals

None Vul

♠ K J 7 2
♥ Q J 10 3
♦ Q J 4
♣ A 7

♠ 5 3

♥ 7 6

♦ 10 5

♣ 9 8 6 5 4 3 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 10 8 4

♥ A K 5

♦ 9 8 6 2

♣ Q 10

♠ A 9 6

♥ 9 8 4 2

♦ A K 7 3

♣ K J

West	North	East	South
		Pass	1NT
Pass	2♠	Pass	3♣
All Pass			
3♣ by South			

Many people play Jacoby Transfer convention. Not all of them play that an initial response of 2♠ asks partner to bid 3♣. You use that here and reply 3♣. Everybody passes.

What a terrible dummy! This shows why this method is a good addition to Jacoby Transfers.

South plays 3♣. West leads the ♥Q. East takes the ♥A K, then switches to the ♠Q.

Loser List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 2 : ♦ = 0 : ♣ = ? :: Total = 3 + ?

Instead of trying to estimate how many ♣ losers you may have, just tell yourself that you can only afford to lose one! Then you base your plan on that requirement.

You might as well win the ♠A. You need to play the trumps from dummy and the easiest way to get there is to play ♦A K, then ruff a ♦. Now play a ♣ from dummy and play what from your hand?

You may think it is a guess whether to play the ♣K or ♣J, but there is no guessing involved here. You must play the ♣J because East cannot possibly hold the ♣A. Just go back and look at the bidding again. The East hand failed to open the bidding in first seat. And since then you have seen the ♥A K and the ♠Q come out of the hand. That's 9 points and the ♣A would bring that total to 13. Since he passed it follows that he doesn't have the ♣A. Of course he might or might not have the ♣Q, you just have to hope for that card.

It's easy to forget the bidding once you have started playing a hand.

But good players don't forget, they use every bit of information they can get to help them make their contracts. That's why they make more contracts.